

MODELLING USERS

Know thyself. Or better yet, know
thy end user

UX design has one primary focus – the end user. It's only logical that the experience be designed with the end user in mind, since it's being designed *for* the end user after all. While the concept may sound simple, this logic is paramount to all things UX. This chapter will teach you about the techniques available to model your end users and their behaviour for the purpose of implementing a successful UX design.

Understanding a Persona

In the world of UX design, a “persona” is not just a deliverable. It's a fictional character invented for the purpose of simulating the needs, behaviours and limitations of the end users of a product, service or brand. To ensure your UX is a good fit to potential customers, you must tailor it to the persona. Obviously, while designing the intended experience, you must think about *who* you're designing for: that is the persona. The persona represents a group of individuals who'll use the product, service or brand in a similar way, or who constitute a similar target audience segment. To predict usage in the beachhead target market, at least one persona must be created (Although, more than one persona is usually created for a product). As a deliverable, personas are a way of manifesting a deep understanding of your customers.